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Artificial Intelligence Acceptable Use Policy (AI AUP)

Lincoln Technical Institute recognizes that generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools like OpenAI's ChatGPT, Microsoft's Bing, and Google's Gemini create significant opportunities to enhance workplace productivity, including efficiency and effectiveness for satisfying critical business objectives. Stated simply, GenAI is a type of artificial intelligence technology that uses large language models to produce human-like writing, images, audio, or video in response to prompts supplied by the user. However, it is imperative that our use of these GenAI tools, including without limitation by our employees, be consistent with Lincoln Technical Institute's values and policies and applicable law.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Acceptable Use Policy (AUP) is to outline the acceptable and responsible use of GenAI tools and technologies within Lincoln Technical Institute for its
employees. The students of Lincoln Technical Institute are subject to their separate AI AUP. This AUP is intended to ensure GenAI is used ethically, legally, and in ways that align with the organization's values and applicable regulations.

2. Scope

This AUP applies to all employees (collectively referred to as "Users") who access or use AI systems, platforms, models, or services provided, authorized, or supported by Lincoln Tech.

3. Acceptable Use

Below are some examples of what could be created using a GenAI tool:

- Emails and letters.
- Blog posts, reports, and other publications.
- Sales and advertising copies.
- Policies and job descriptions.
- Spreadsheet calculations.

- Foreign language translations.
- Coding development or debugging.
- Document or information sorting.
- Outlines or summaries of internal or external information.

Acceptable uses include:

- Uses aligned with your role or academic responsibilities.
- For general knowledge questions meant to enhance your understanding on a work-related topic.
- To brainstorm ideas related to projects you are working on.
- To create formulas for Excel spreadsheets or similar programs.
- To develop or debug code, verify before deployment.
- To draft an email or letter.
- To summarize online research or create outlines for content projects to assist in full coverage of a topic.

When using GenAI tools for the uses above, Users must do so in the following manner:

- Transparent, explainable, and auditable when used in decision-making processes.
- Respectful of individual privacy, data protection regulations (e.g., GDPRHIPAA), and intellectual property rights.
- Inclusive and free from discriminatory or biased outputs or behavior.
- Secure and free from malicious intent, including avoiding the creation of malware, deepfakes, or disinformation.

4. Prohibited Use

Users may not use AI systems for any of the following:

- To make employment decisions about applicants or team members, including recruitment, hiring, promotions, transfers, performance ratings, corrective actions, demotions, and dismissals.

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- Engaging in or facilitating illegal activities.
- Generating, spreading, or amplifying misinformation or disinformation.
- Harassing, threatening, or discriminating against individuals or groups.
- Creating deepfakes or manipulated content intended to deceive or defame.
- Infringing on intellectual property or violating copyrights.
- Using AI for surveillance or profiling without proper authorization or legal basis.
- Automating decisions that significantly affect individuals (e.g., hiring, credit scoring, disciplinary actions) without human oversight.
- Copying and pasting, typing, or in any way submitting proprietary information or data of any kind into a GenAI tool chatbot.
- Circumventing access controls, security protocols, or data protection mechanisms.
- Attempting to reverse engineer, manipulate, or exploit AI systems in unauthorized ways.

5. Approval – Tools.

Except for GenAI tools approved as stated in Appendix A, Users who wish to use GenAI tools for work purposes should submit a request to the **Neal Goldstein, Chief Information Officer**. In your submission, please identify (1) the specific tool(s) you intend to use (e.g., ChatGPT),
(2) the purpose(s) for which you intend to use it or them, and (3) the categories of data you intend to input for that or those purpose(s). Users may use GenAI tools for approved work purposes solely on Lincoln Technical Institute systems, workstations, and devices. When using such tools for work purposes, Users must use their Lincoln Technical Institute-provided email addresses as credentials when creating and using an account with the GenAI tool.

6. Data and Privacy Considerations

- Users must not input confidential, sensitive, or personally identifiable information (PII) into public or non-secure AI systems without proper authorization.

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- AI systems must be used in compliance with Lincoln Tech's data protection policies and applicable data privacy laws.
- Data used for training or testing AI systems must be vetted to avoid bias, ensure quality, and comply with data usage rights.
- Accordingly, asking a GenAI tool to, for instance, summarize Lincoln Tech's financials, turn a strategy memo into a PowerPoint deck, or prepare a response to a student regarding a specific problem that occurred, would NOT be acceptable uses of GenAI tools.

7. Transparency and Accountability

- Users must disclose when content is generated or assisted by AI when:
    - The work will be evaluated, published, or used for decision-making.
    - It is required by specific departmental, academic, or professional standards.
- Disclosure of AI use is not required for:
    - Routine tasks like grammar checking, spell-checking, or formatting.
    - Brainstorming, outlining, or idea generation.
    - Administrative tasks (summarizing meetings for personal notes, scheduling, etc.).
    - Using AI as a search or reference tool.
- Users must closely review and check all outputs from GenAI tools. Though their outputs are polished and credible sounding, GenAI tools routinely generate responses that are factually inaccurate and/or that may be inconsistent with our business practices, principles, obligations, and objectives. If a User is unable to

independently verify that a GenAI tool's output is factually accurate and consistent with our business practices, principles, obligations, and objectives, they must, prior to use, submit the output to their manager for review and approval before that output may be used or disclosed.

- Any potential use of GenAI tools to assist with decision-making – e.g., with

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respect to how to respond to a student complaint, which students to offer an accommodation must be approved by **Neal Goldstein, Chief Information Officer**. These tools may have embedded biases about which we are unaware, and their use to assist with decision-making may trigger a number of legal, ethical, and business issues that need to be carefully considered. As noted above, to the extent permitted under this AUP, Users must use GenAI tools in compliance with all equal employment opportunities, anti-discrimination, and anti-harassment policies. GenAI tools must not be used to create content that is inappropriate, discriminatory, harassing, or otherwise harmful to any individual, such as deepfakes, digital images, or similar content. GenAI tool misuse can and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. AI-generated outputs should not be used as the sole basis for significant decisions without human review.

8. Enforcement and Violations

In addition to this AUP, all use of GenAI tools by Lincoln Technical Institute employees while performing in their assigned role for Lincoln Technical Institute is subject to all applicable Lincoln Technical Institute policies and procedures, including the Written Information Security Policy, Acceptable Use Policy, and Confidentiality Policies. Failure to comply with this AUP and/or those policies may subject Users to discipline, up to and including termination of their employment or relationship with Lincoln Technical Institute.

Violations may result in:

- Suspension or termination of access to AI tools and systems.
- Disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or expulsion.
- Legal action if the violation involves criminal activity or regulatory breaches.

9. Monitoring.

At all times, Lincoln Technical Institute has the right, but not the obligation, to access, monitor, and record employee use of GenAI tools on its information systems. Employees should not have any expectation of privacy with respect to any inputs to or outputs from GenAI tools used or accessed on or through Lincoln Technical Institute's information systems.

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10. Subscriptions.

Currently, Lincoln Technical Institute is not reimbursing the cost of any subscription for AI GenAI tools, unless expressly approved by Lincoln Technical Institute. If you would like to enroll in a subscription for a GenAI tool to be used solely for work-related purposes at
Lincoln Technical Institute, contact **Neal Goldstein, Chief Information Officer.**

11. Policy Review and Updates

This AUP will be reviewed regularly and updated as necessary to reflect changes in technology, law, or organizational practices. Users are responsible for staying informed about the latest version of the policy.

12. Contact

Please direct any questions regarding AUP or about the use of GenAI in connection with your work for Lincoln Technical Institute to **Neal Goldstein, Chief Information Officer.** Users should promptly report any suspected violations of this AUP, or violations of other applicable policies stemming from the use of GenAI tools, to **Neal Goldstein, Chief**
Information Officer

Appendix A – Approved Generative AI Tools

The following Generative AI tools have been approved for use by Lincoln Technical Institute employees for approved purposes:

- General Staff: Microsoft Copilot and ALEX at Admired Leadership
- Technical Staff and Software Developers: All tools approved for General Staff, plus Claude and Google Gemini